

Week 1: Décrire plus précisément une personne

JSS3 French — First Term Lesson Note (Deep-Dive Edition)

Introduction

This week builds on basic description skills learned in JSS1–2, teaching students to describe a person more precisely — both their physical appearance and their character — using correctly agreeing qualifying adjectives (**les adjectifs qualificatifs**).

Vocabulaire: La description physique (Physical Description)

Français	English
grand(e) / petit(e)	tall / short
mince / gros(se)	slim / fat
les cheveux longs / courts	long / short hair
les cheveux noirs / bruns	black / brown hair
les yeux marron / noirs	brown / black eyes
jeune / vieux (vieille)	young / old
beau (belle)	handsome/beautiful

Vocabulaire: La description morale (Personality/Character)

Français	English
gentil(le)	kind
sympathique	nice, friendly
intelligent(e)	intelligent
timide	shy
paresseux (paresseuse)	lazy
travailleur (travailleuse)	hardworking
patient(e)	patient

Grammaire: L'accord des adjectifs qualificatifs

Qualifying adjectives in French must **agree in gender and number** with the noun they describe. Generally, add **-e** for the feminine form, and **-s** for the plural form (unless the adjective already ends in -e or -s).

Masculin singulier	Féminin singulier	Masculin pluriel	Féminin pluriel
grand	grande	grands	grandes

intelligent	intelligente	intelligents	intelligentes
gentil	gentille	gentils	gentilles
beau	belle	beaux	belles

Exemples

Il est grand et mince. Il a les cheveux courts et noirs. (He is tall and slim. He has short, black hair.)

Elle est petite et sympathique; elle a les yeux marron. (She is short and friendly; she has brown eyes.)

Mon meilleur ami est très intelligent et travailleur. (My best friend is very intelligent and hardworking.)

Real-Life Application

Students can use this vocabulary and grammar to describe a family member, a friend, or a favourite teacher in French, both in writing and in spoken conversation — a common task in BECE oral and written French examinations.

Evaluation Questions

- 1 Translate into French: “She is tall and intelligent.”
- 2 Write the feminine singular form of “grand” and “gentil.”
- 3 Write the masculine plural form of “intelligent” and “beau.”
- 4 Complete: “Il est _____ (kind) et _____ (hardworking).”
- 5 Describe your best friend's physical appearance in three French sentences.
- 6 Translate into English: “Elle a les cheveux longs et bruns.”
- 7 Correct this sentence: “Ma sœur est grand et intelligent.”
- 8 Give the French word for “shy” and use it in a sentence.
- 9 Write two adjectives describing personality and two describing physical appearance.
- 10 Describe yourself in four French sentences, using at least two qualifying adjectives correctly agreed.